

Using GIMP to Increase Business Productivity

GIMP or GNU Image Manipulation Program is a cross-platform, open source image editor. In our last article on GIMP (published in the January 2020 issue of *OSFY*), we explored some features of the tool. Continuing it further, here are some more.



GIMP 2.10 ships with a number of the improvements requested by digital painters. One of the most interesting new additions is the MyPaint Brush tool that first appeared in the GIMP-Painter fork.

The 'Smudge' tool has got updates specifically targeted at painting related use cases. The new 'No erase effect' option prevents the tools from changing the alpha of pixels, and the foreground colour can now be blended into smudged pixels controlled by a new 'Flow' slider, where '0' means no blending.

All painting tools now have explicit 'Hardness' and 'Force' sliders, except for the MyPaint Brush tool, which only has the 'Hardness' slider. GIMP now supports canvas rotation and flipping to help illustrators check proportions and perspective.

A new 'Brush lock to view' option gives one a choice to lock a brush at a certain zoom level and rotate the angle of the canvas. The option is available for all painting tools that use a brush, except for the MyPaint Brush tool.

A new 'Symmetry Painting' dockable dialogue box, enabled on a per-image basis, allows one to use all

painting tools with various symmetries (mirror, mandala, tiling...). This new version of GIMP also ships with more new brushes, which are available by default. Some of the new GEGL-based filters—Exposure, Shadows-Highlights, High-pass, Wavelet Decompose, Panorama Projection and others—are specifically targeted at photographers.

Apart from that, the new 'Extract Component' filter simplifies extracting a channel of an arbitrary colour model (LAB, LCH, CMYK, etc) from the currently selected layer. If one is used to decomposing and recomposing images, it will be easier now.